> tolerance, a culture of acceptance seems to be intellectually less domineering than China.[31]

Four Indian cultures of pluralism

The following four subsections proceed to examine how India's new approach to soft power has been put into practice. To promote its culture of pluralism, the government has focused on four dimensions: *religious* diversity and tolerance, the *social* practice of yoga, the *political* values and institutions of democracy, and *economic* innovation and entrepreneurship. In all four instances, the strategic objective is two-fold, even if only implicitly apparent. At the global level, this cultural emphasis seeks to distinguish India from China's authoritarian and state-centric model of governance and development and thus offer an Asian alternative portrayed to be more liberal, inclusive, and sustainable. At the regional level, on the other hand, New Delhi's cultural soft power diplomacy seeks to reassure smaller states in the neighbourhood that, despite its predominance, India is driven by benign and peaceful intentions with unique selling points.

Buddhism and Sufism as a religious culture of pluralism

Shashi Tharoor, the former chairman of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs, has famously referenced India's religious diversity as a source of soft power: